

# How we grade trades

A short brief for the league. What the tracker does today, where we are leaning, and a survey so we can tilt the book the way this room actually trades. Live tape: <https://slabslip.github.io/cuckle-trade-tracker/>

We grade completed Sleeper trades so an argument has one tape instead of ten gut feels. This league drafts four rounds. The cheapest pick that exists here is a late 4th. There are no 5ths.

**A trade score is what you got minus what you gave, looked at on one clock at a time.**

## 1. How a name gets a number

Every player and pick is priced on a public Superflex trade board (DynastyProcess). About 10,000 means the best player in fantasy. That is trade value — not fantasy points, not dollars.

Raw boards are steep. Next to Josh Allen, a mid-tier name can look like nothing. Real rooms do not trade that way. So we **lift mid-tier names** — Baker, a mid 2nd, a late 4th — so they still count. The lifted number is what the live tape scores. The raw leftover is not.

| Name                           | Raw board | After we lift mid-tier |
|--------------------------------|-----------|------------------------|
| Josh Allen                     | 10,232    | 10,000                 |
| 2026 1.01                      | 7,311     | 7,438                  |
| Baker Mayfield                 | 2,588     | 4,563                  |
| 2026 pick 2.07                 | 306       | 2,938                  |
| Tyreek Hill                    | 285       | 2,892                  |
| Ezekiel Elliott                | 3         | 856                    |
| Late 4th (this league's floor) | ~14       | ~1,300                 |

### The fork this league has to decide

A late 4th is about 14 on the raw board and about 1,300 after the lift. If this room treats late 3rds and 4ths as lottery tickets, 1,300 is too high. If they are real assets in a four-round draft, that lift is the point.

## 2. Picks in this league

Once a pick is used, we grade the **player it became** — unless you ask “what was the pick the day we traded.”

This year's pick uses the real slot (through 4.10). Next year is early / mid / late by round. Further out is a mid pick. 2029 is priced like 2028 until the public board adds 2029.

We do **not** add a homemade “draft is next month” bump. If the public board rises as the draft gets close, we rise with it. If it stays flat, we stay flat.

If you flipped the pick before the draft, the trade still follows who got drafted. Your sale profit is a separate story. We do not add those two together.

### 3. Why one clock lies

Same bags. Different question. We never mash two clocks into one number.

| Clock                          | Question                                              |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Day of the trade               | What did we click accept on?                          |
| First 1 / 2 / 3 years          | What were the bags worth while it still mattered?     |
| Since the trade (site default) | What has the deal been worth from that day until now? |

#### Zeke + Hill vs Saquon + Chubb

2019-07-26

ChiefGumby got the picks that became Zeke and Tyreek. ARae got the picks that became Saquon and Chubb. Numbers below are the live lifted tape — not the raw board leftovers (Zeke 3, Hill 285).

| Clock           | Chief got                     | Chief gave                       | Score  |
|-----------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|
| Today           | 3,748 (Zeke 856 + Hill 2,892) | 5,152 (Saquon 4,391 + Chubb 761) | -1,404 |
| First 3 years   | 13,263                        | 13,404                           | -141   |
| Since the trade | 9,660                         | 10,757                           | -1,097 |

Today still says Chief is behind. The first years say the bags lived in the same galaxy — almost even. The raw board would have scored today as Zeke 3 + Hill 285. The site does not. That is why “today” and “over time” both exist.

### 4. Extra pieces and a star

Adding names is not the same as trading a star for a pile. We still price every name. Then the side that keeps the best player can get a bonus:

**Bonus = 15% of your best player × how many extra lesser pieces they sent you**

A 1-for-1 gets no bonus. Dart throws for a mid player get a small bonus. The 15% only bites when you actually moved a star.

#### CeeDee for six pieces

2025-09-04

TrumanCooper got CeeDee (7,673). TedCumberbatch got CMC, Brian Robinson, Marvin Mims, plus a 2028 1st, 2nd, and 4th (16,857).

| Step             | CeeDee side | Six-piece side |
|------------------|-------------|----------------|
| Names added up   | 7,673       | 16,857         |
| Star bonus       | +5,755      | 0              |
| Bag              | 13,428      | 16,857         |
| Score for Truman |             | -3,429         |

The star is not treated as one lonely line. One WR still does not beat six assets. That +5,755 matched KeepTradeCut on the same bag (±3).

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## 5. Where we are leaning (not live yet)

We will not change the live site until the league votes. These are leanings, not law.

| Topic                                                        | We are leaning                                                   | Why                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Late 3rds and 4ths                                           | Maybe lift them less than today                                  | ~1,300 for a late 4th may over-pay a dart throw                                                   |
| Star bonus                                                   | Keep 15%, cap extras at 3                                        | Stops a 1-for-6 from printing a huge bonus                                                        |
| A late 4th as an "extra piece"                               | Count it as half a piece                                         | A 4th is not CMC                                                                                  |
| Picks as the draft gets close                                | No homemade bump unless you say they rise                        | We already follow the public board over time                                                      |
| Picks vs proven players                                      | No extra "picks are worse" haircut until you vote                | The Superflex board already prices risk                                                           |
| QB vs RB vs WR vs TE                                         | No extra position slider yet                                     | Superflex already pays QBs more. Our own RB/WR tilt needs a vote                                  |
| Cheap-but-real names (Hill is 285 raw, 2,892 after the lift) | Keep scoring the lifted today number                             | The raw leftover is not what the room traded. Zeroing Hill turns old smash trades into tombstones |
| Retired names (live Zeke is 856 after the lift)              | Maybe treat a retiree as 0                                       | A leftover raw 3 is not a career. The live book still lifts it until you vote                     |
| Dead years vs cheap picks                                    | A dead player year can count as 0. A still-a-pick 4th should not | A cheap pick is not a retiree                                                                     |
| Default clock in arguments                                   | Since the trade, with day-of and first 3 years next to it        | One number is a fight. Three clocks is a conversation                                             |

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## 6. Survey

For most items use: much less / a bit less / about right / a bit more / much more. Answer as a GM, not as last year's standing. This league = 1sts through 4ths only.

### Picks

1. Do picks go up in value for you as we get close to the draft?
2. Are picks worth less in this room than KeepTradeCut or DynastyProcess say?
3. Do you only really value early firsts? Do 2nds still matter? 3rds? Late 4ths?
4. Would you trade a rostered starter for a late 4th, or is that pick almost nothing?
5. A 4th two years out vs this year's 4th — same price, or cheaper?

### Positions

6. Superflex QBs: too expensive on the public board, about right, or still cheap vs skill players?
7. RBs: do you fade them earlier than the board does (injury / age)?
8. WRs: do you pay extra for three years of life vs a win-now RB?
9. TEs: scarce enough to pay up, or just best available?
0. If you must stack a rebuild: young WR, young RB, or picks?

## Trade shape

1. In a 1-for-4, should the star get a bonus even if the four names add up to more?
2. CeeDee-for-six got +5,755 on the star. Too little, about right, or too much?
3. Should a late 4th count as a full extra piece, half a piece, or ignore it?
4. Should we cap how many extra pieces can boost a star (for example, max 3)?

## Time

5. When you argue a trade, which clock do you want first: day of the trade, first 3 years, or since the trade?
6. Is three years the right “did it hit” window, or do you want 2 / 4 / career?

## Short answers

7. Name one trade on our tape the current book gets wrong — and why.
8. What do you actually use to trade: KeepTradeCut, DynastyProcess, gut, something else?
9. Anything else that should move a number (taxi, that week’s playoff push, “he’s my guy”)?

### Fine print (the cases that change a grade)

- **No Superflex price** (mostly IDP) — listed, not scored as zero.
- **FAAB / waiver cash** — not a trade piece.
- **One-way gifts** — off the grade.
- **3-team / you sent nothing** — still graded as what you received.
- **2019 startup** — no original pick prices; we use the earliest board we have.
- **You flipped the pick** — the trade still follows who got drafted; your sale is separate.
- **Injury mid-year** — a year-end board can miss a June ACL that healed by December.
- **Retired / off the board** — today keeps the last known lifted number (Zeke at 856). The raw board leftover is 3. First-years can treat a dead year as 0.
- **Still playing, cheap on the raw board** — lift them (Hill 2,892 today). Do not score the raw leftover 285 as the today value.
- **Still a pick** — priced as a pick, not as a retired player.
- **Win-now / Balanced labels** — describe the bag. They do not change the score.

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Votes tell us whether to lift late picks less, cap the star bonus, count a 4th as half a piece, and whether QBs / RBs / WRs need our own tilt on top of Superflex. We will not invent a 2019–2025 KeepTradeCut history we cannot source. One book. One clock per number.